Uttar Pradesh's Solar Revolution: Building a Clean Energy Future



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Under Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, Uttar Pradesh is turning its solar potential into new generation capacity, transmission infrastructure and wider use of renewable energy across cities and agriculture. For years, the dry stretches of Bundelkhand were discussed mainly in terms of their challenges for agriculture. Their abundant sunlight offers another possibility. The Uttar Pradesh Solar Energy Policy 2022 set a target of 22,000 MW of solar capacity by 2026-27, making the region an important part of the state's renewable energy plans.

For Yogi Adityanath's government, the objective goes beyond adding solar power to the grid. As Uttar Pradesh expands its industrial base, electricity demand is rising. Increasing renewable generation, attracting private investment and building the infrastructure to transmit that power have therefore become part of the state's wider development strategy.



The Projects Behind the Solar Push

The clearest sign of progress is the movement from plans to projects. In March 2023, the Centre approved eight solar parks with a combined capacity of 4,995 MW in Bundelkhand. The 1,200 MW Jalaun Ultra Mega Renewable Energy Power Park subsequently reached the foundation-stone stage. The project represents an estimated ₹797 crore investment and is expected to create around 7,000 construction jobs and 700 operations and maintenance opportunities. Progress has also been visible outside Bundelkhand. In February 2024, SJVN commissioned a 50 MW solar power station in Kanpur Dehat, developed at a cost of around ₹281 crore.

The financial commitment has also expanded. In the 2026-27 Uttar Pradesh Budget, around ₹2,104 crore was allocated for solar, bio-energy and green hydrogen development, more than double the allocation in 2025-26.

Together, these projects and investments show that the state's solar ambitions are beginning to translate into generation capacity and wider renewable-energy infrastructure.

Making Solar More Reliable

Adding generation capacity is only one part of the challenge. Renewable power produced in Bundelkhand needs transmission infrastructure to reach the wider state. The policy provides for a Green Energy Corridor to facilitate the evacuation of 4,000 MW of solar power from Bundelkhand. It also recognises the importance of storage as solar generation expands. Eligible utility-scale projects with four-hour battery storage can receive a state subsidy of ₹2.5 crore per MW. For a state seeking to attract energy-intensive industries, these investments matter because the value of renewable power depends not only on how much is generated, but also on whether it can be delivered when and where it is needed.

Taking Solar Into Cities and Farms

Yogi Adityanath's renewable-energy push also extends beyond large solar parks. Ayodhya has been developed as Uttar Pradesh's first Model Solar City, with 40 MW of solar generation and more than 2,500 solar-powered streetlights. The programme is planned to expand to 16 municipal corporations and Noida.

The shift is also reaching individual households. As of June 2026, more than 6.2 lakh households in Uttar Pradesh had been covered under the PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana, accounting for roughly 17% of rooftop solar installations nationwide, the highest share of any state.

In rural areas, the policy provides for the solarisation of agricultural feeders and private grid-connected tube wells, bringing renewable energy into the state's agricultural power network. The transition also requires people who can install and maintain the new infrastructure. Uttar Pradesh has set a target of training 30,000 youths as Surya Mitras over five years.

What matters now is what Uttar Pradesh builds around its renewable capacity. Reaching 22,000 MW will require more than solar plants; it will also depend on stronger transmission, storage, skills and wider adoption. The projects and investments already underway indicate that the state's solar ambitions are beginning to translate into assets on the ground and a broader economic opportunity.